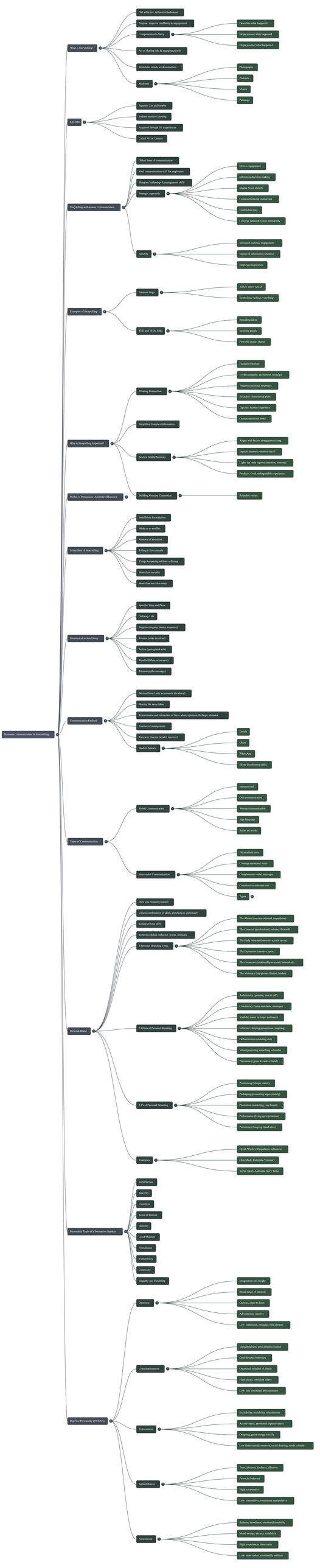
Business Communication & Storytelling
What is Storytelling?
Old, effective, influential technique
Purpose: improve credibility & engagement
Components of a Story
Describes what happened
Helps you see what happened
Helps you feel what happened
Art of sharing info & engaging people
Stimulates minds, evokes emotion
Mediums
Photographs
Podcasts
Videos
Paintings
SATORI
Japanese Zen philosophy
Sudden intuitive learning
Acquired through life experiences
Called Wu in Chinese
Storytelling in Business Communication
Oldest form of communication
Vital communication skill for employees
Sharpens leadership & management skills
Strategic Approach
Drives engagement
Influences decision-making
Shapes brand identity
Creates emotional connection
Establishes trust
Conveys values & vision memorably
Benefits
Increased audience engagement
Improved information retention
Employee inspiration
Examples of Storytelling
Amazon Logo
Yellow arrow A to Z
Symbolizes 'selling everything'
TED and TEDx Talks
Spreading ideas
Inspiring people
Powerful stories shared
Why is Storytelling Important?
Creating Connection
Engages emotions
Evokes empathy, excitement, nostalgia
Triggers emotional responses
Relatable characters & plots
Taps into human experience
Creates emotional bond
Simplifies Complex Information
Science behind Memory
Aligns with brain's strategy/processing
Impacts memory retention/recall
Lights up brain regions (emotion, sensory)
Produces vivid, unforgettable experiences
Modes of Persuasion (Aristotle's Rhetoric)
Building Genuine Connection
Relatable stories
Seven Sins of Storytelling
Insufficient Presentation
Weak or no conflict
Absence of sensation
Telling it from outside
Things happening without suffering
More than one plot
More than one take-away
Structure of a Good Story
Specific Time and Place
Ordinary Life
Surprise (tragedy, drama, suspense)
Tension (risks involved)
Action (protagonist acts)
Results (failure or success)
Takeaway (the message)
Communication Defined
Derived from Latin 'communis' ('to share')
Sharing the same ideas
Transmission and interaction of facts, ideas, opinions, feelings, attitudes
Essence of management
Two-way process (sender, receiver)
Modern Modes
Emails
Chats
WhatsApp
Skype (conference calls)
Types of Communication
Verbal Communication
Interpersonal
Oral communication
Written communication
Sign language
Relies on words
Non-verbal Communication
Physicalized cues
Conveys emotional states
Complements verbal messages
Conscious or subconscious
Types
Personal Brand
How you promote yourself
Unique combination of skills, experiences, personality
Telling of your story
Reflects conduct, behavior, words, attitudes
4 Personal Branding Types
The Altruist (service-oriented, empathetic)
The Careerist (professional, industry-focused)
The Early Adopter (innovative, tech-savvy)
The Expressive (creative, open)
The Connector (relationship-oriented, networked)
The Visionary (big-picture thinker, leader)
7 Pillars of Personal Branding
Authenticity (genuine, true to self)
Consistency (same standards, message)
Visibility (seen by target audience)
Influence (shaping perceptions, inspiring)
Differentiation (standing out)
Value (providing something valuable)
Persistence (grow & evolve brand)
5 Pc of Personal Branding
Positioning (unique stance)
Packaging (presenting appropriately)
Promotion (marketing your brand)
Performance (living up to promises)
Persistence (keeping brand alive)
Examples
Oprah Winfrey: Empathetic Influencer
Elon Musk: Futuristic Visionary
Taylor Swift: Authentic Story Teller
Personality Traits of a Persuasive Speaker
Imperfection
Sincerity
Closeness
Sense of humour
Humility
Good Manners
Friendliness
Vulnerability
Generosity
Empathy and Flexibility
Big Five Personality (OCEAN)
Openness
Imagination and insight
Broad range of interests
Curious, eager to learn
Adventurous, creative
Low: traditional, struggles with abstract
Conscientiousness
Thoughtfulness, good impulse control
Goal-directed behaviors
Organized, mindful of details
Plans ahead, considers others
Low: less structured, procrastinates
Extroversion
Excitability, sociability, talkativeness
Assertiveness, emotional expressiveness
Outgoing, gains energy socially
Low (Introverted): reserved, social draining, needs solitude
Agreeableness
Trust, altruism, kindness, affection
Prosocial behavior
High: cooperative
Low: competitive, sometimes manipulative
Neuroticism
Sadness, moodiness, emotional instability
Mood swings, anxiety, irritability
High: experiences these traits
Low: more stable, emotionally resilient